

Wednesday, 12 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Clear

33° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

34° 15°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

33° 17°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

26° 17°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Fourth ex-police officer arrested over child abuse.

Women abused by grooming gangs say they were also exploited by serving police officers.

UK · NEWS

2

Former army translator jailed for raping woman in private hire car.

Abdul Nabizada, who worked with the British army in Afghanistan, attacked the woman while driving her home from a night out.

UK · NEWS

3

Antisemitism towards Jewish children 'shocking', government expert tells BBC.

It's one of the findings from an independent review into antisemitism in schools and colleges.

UK · NEWS

4

Girl, 6, dies and another child hurt in A12 crash.

Specialist officers are supporting the girl's family, Essex Police says.

UK · NEWS

5

Golfer left shaking by 411-yard hole in one.

Matthew Vigurs says England Golf believes his shot had a one in six million chance of happening.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Anne Hathaway pokes fun at 'fake baby bump' theories.**
The actress responds to social media critics who suggested her bump didn't look real at a premiere.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Amanda Knox comedy show 'sincere' but 'just not very funny'.**
The Edinburgh Fringe show received a mixed response, with many reviewers saying typical stand-up fare.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 30 years later, a former gang member will stand trial for Tupac's murder.**
It's been three decades since Tupac was killed, and since then, his reputation has only grown.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Radio Caroline breached Ofcom rules after mistakenly announcing King's death.**
A correction and apology wasn't aired until 30 minutes after the incident occurred.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Ex-Cambridge professor Jason Arday cancels live event after plagiarism row.**
One talk by Arday is "cancelled at the request of the speaker" and others are removed from listings.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 The map showing world's division over Infantino.**
BBC Sport uses visuals to explore the support and opposition to Gianni Infantino's leadership of Fifa from its members.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Hodgkinson and gold medal rivals progress at Europeans.**
Keely Hodgkinson and gold medal rivals Audrey Werro and Femke Broeders-Bol progress to remain on course for a tantalising European 800m showdown.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Palace co-owner spoke to McNeil's partner before move.**
Crystal Palace co-owner and chairman Steve Parish contacts Dwight McNeil's partner before the midfielder's move to the club.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Unhappy PSG given extra Super Cup dressing room.**
Champions League winners Paris St-Germain were unhappy with the space they were given at Red Bull Arena.
SPORT · UK
- 5 How £30m Charles became Northern Ireland's most expensive footballer.**
After he became Northern Ireland's most expensive player, BBC Sport NI looks at the rise of Shea Charles, from Manchester City's academy to Fulham's £30m man.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Cold-water taps for filling pets' bowls and watering cans are the surprise garden-centre hit.**
With more of us gardening, small convenience gadgets are booming — though the watering can remains undefeated.
- 2 Knitting and crochet are booming with a new generation, sold as the ultimate screen-free wind-down.**
Beginners start with scarves and quietly accumulate wool. The first project, makers admit, is usually 'a bit wonky but loved'.
- 3 A study finds the average person has a 'comfort route' they walk or drive even when there's a faster way.**
Familiarity, not speed, wins. We'd rather the known road with the nice tree than save three minutes on the ring road.
- 4 More of us are batch-cooking at the weekend to dodge the weeknight scramble.**
Freezers are filling with portioned dinners. The classic mistake: forgetting to label them, then playing 'mystery soup' on a Wednesday.
- 5 The great British picnic is being upgraded, with sales of fold-out chairs and cool bags climbing.**
We're venturing out more, weather permitting. The traditional picnic still ends, as ever, with at least one item dropped in the grass.
- 6 Tinned fish is unexpectedly trendy again, with younger shoppers leading the charge.**
Sardines and mackerel are being repackaged as a quick, cheap protein. Older shoppers are quietly baffled, having eaten it for decades.
- 7 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 7 in 10 of us have lied about THIS to get off the phone faster.
ANSWER: 'OH, YOU'RE BREAKING UP, I'M GOING INTO A TUNNEL.'

Q The most common thing we Google late at night is apparently THIS.
ANSWER: WHETHER IT'S NORMAL THAT OUR KNEE JUST DID THAT.

TALK TOPIC

- **A study claims the song you loved at 14 is the one you'll love forever.**
What was yours — and are you brave enough to admit it on air?
- **Most people apparently have one job they wanted as a child and completely abandoned.**
What did you want to be? And how far did real life take you from it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **The Human Body.** Your nose can detect roughly a trillion different smells, far more than the handful of basic categories scientists once assumed.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Doctors have identified a condition, nicknamed 'phantom buzz', where people are so used to their phone vibrating they feel it even when the phone is in another room — and it now has its own NHS leaflet.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A bolt of lightning contains enough energy to toast around 100,000 slices of bread.
- The Eiffel Tower has its own secret little apartment near the top.
- Reindeer eyes change colour with the seasons, from gold in summer to blue in winter.
- The first webcam was invented to monitor a coffee pot at Cambridge University.
- Apples float because they're around a quarter air.
- The blue whale is the largest animal ever known to have lived, bigger than any dinosaur.
- A 'quidnunc' is a real word for a nosey person who always wants the latest gossip.
- Greenland sharks can live for several hundred years, making them the longest-living vertebrates.

On this day

Day 224 of the year, 141 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Euplius; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Milan; Christian feast day: Herculanius of Brescia; Christian feast day: Pope Innocent XI. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1988 — Tyson Fury, English boxer
- 1949 — Mark Knopfler, Scottish-English singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1972 — Del the Funky Homosapien, American rapper
- 1927 — Porter Wagoner, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2007)
- 1975 — Casey Affleck, American actor
- 1954 — Pat Metheny, American jazz guitarist and composer
- 1999 — GK Barry, social media star and presenter
- 1980 — Dominique Swain, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1944 — Waffen-SS troops massacre 560 people in Sant'Anna di Stazzema.
- 1976 — Between 1,000 and 3,500 Palestinians are killed in the Tel al-Zaatar massacre, one of the bloodiest events of the Lebanese Civil War.
- 1952 — The Night of the Murdered Poets: Thirteen prominent Jewish intellectuals are murdered in Moscow, Russia, Soviet Union.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1985 — Japan Air Lines Flight 123, a Boeing 747, crashes into Osutaka ridge in Gunma Prefecture, Japan, killing 520, becoming the worst single-plane air disaster.
- 1944 — Nazi German troops end the week-long Wola massacre, during which time at least 40,000 people are killed indiscriminately or in mass executions.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1976 — Between 1,000 and 3,500 Palestinians are killed in the Tel al-Zaatar massacre, one of the bloodiest events of the Lebanese Civil War.
- 1950 — Korean War: Bloody Gulch massacre: Seventy-five American POWs are massacred by the North Korean Army.

- 1953 — Thermonuclear bomb testing: The Soviet atomic bomb project continues with the detonation of "RDS-6s" (Joe 4) using a "layered" scheme.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 225 of the year, 140 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Benedetto Sinigardi; Christian feast day: Benildus Romançon; Christian feast day: Cassian of Imola; Christian feast day: Clara Maass (Lutheran Church). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — James Morrison, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1921 — Jimmy McCracklin, American blues/R&B singer-songwriter and pianist (died 2012)
- 1961 — Dawnn Lewis, American actress
- 1964 — Debi Mazar, American actress
- 1982 — Sebastian Stan, Romanian-American actor
- 1959 — Bruce French, English cricketer and coach
- 1962 — John Slattery, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1970 — Seana Kofoed, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1960 — The Central African Republic declares independence from France.
- 2008 — Russo-Georgian War: Russian units occupy the Georgian city of Gori.
- 1913 — First production in the UK of stainless steel by Harry Brearley.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1954 — Radio Pakistan broadcasts the "Qaumī Tarāna", the national anthem of Pakistan for the first time.
- 1940 — World War II: The German Luftwaffe launches an air operation, codenamed Adlertag, during the Battle of Britain in an attempt to destroy the British Royal Air Force.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)